

Core Concepts: Build an EOL Reporting Agent

In this section, you'll build a 3-layer agent architecture for tracking End of Service (EOS) and End of Life (EOL) dates for AWS resources. Each phase builds on the previous one, and you'll experience why each layer exists by hitting the limitations of the previous approach first.

Phase	Layer	What You'll Build	Key Lesson
1.1	Steering	EOL reporting rules + report format	Rules that are always present in every conversation
1.2	Skill	EOL data retrieval procedures	Extract procedures so they load only when needed
1.3	Custom Agent	Dedicated EOL reporting identity	A purpose-built agent that ties it all together

The Story Arc

1. **Steering** — "I taught Kiro the rules" -> Everything works, but the file is bloated with both rules and procedures
2. **Skills** — "I packaged the procedures so they load only when needed" -> Context is lean, procedures are reusable
3. **Custom Agent** — "I built a dedicated agent that owns the rules and ties it all together" -> A purpose-built identity with full rulebook, steering becomes a routing pointer

Each phase builds on the previous one. Let's start with Steering.